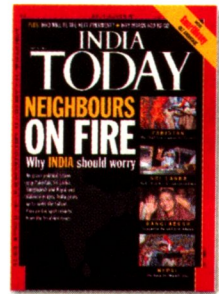


SUMEET INDER SINGH



"Why India Should Worry",
May 28, 2007

"Escalating violence may fuel the growth of fundamentalist forces. India should maintain good relations with neighbours to prevent hostility."

SHYAMA MURTHY, *Hyderabad*

Fighting Frontiers

Living in a glasshouse of its own tensions and turmoil, India cannot point fingers at its erring neighbours ("Why India Should Worry", May 28). While there is a serious threat to our security and economic growth, we can only keep our fingers crossed and hope our neighbours solve their own problems soon.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR
Bangalore

Your cover story is thought provoking. Instability and political turmoil are at their peak in the subcontinent and India should be cautious of its neighbours.

K.S.THAMPI,
Chennai

According to vaastu shashtra, a country is bound to face problems if it has mountains in the north and water bodies in the south. That explains why India is

gripped by problems. Be it Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal or Sri Lanka, political turmoil is synonymous with the subcontinent.

S.S. RAMANATHA RAO,
Bangalore

India should show high diplomatic skill to safeguard its own interests. Pakistan and Sri Lanka are at flashpoints due to terrorism. Nepal and Bangladesh, too, are passing through internal turmoil. Only a strong will coupled with proper diplomacy can see us through this mounting tension.

SOHAM SRIVASTAVA, *Delhi*

Sri Lanka might want India's increased involvement in its affairs, but can we forget what happened to Rajiv Gandhi? The conflict between the LTTE and the Lankan Government seems to be never-ending. Now that the Tigers have acquired technology to target

nuclear facilities in south India, it's best to be careful and mind our own business.

MANAB KHARKATARY, *Delhi*

Among all its neighbours, India must worry most about Bangladesh. Very soon it will change the demographics of the country with its relentless export of illegal migrants. Assam, for instance, may have a Bangladeshi chief minister in the next 15 years.

JITUMONI BEZBORUAH,
Dhuburi, Assam

When religion and politics are mixed, a nation is destined to face crisis. This logic holds true for Pakistan and Bangladesh. I feel proud to be an Indian when I look at our political maturity. Although we have corrupt and criminal ministers, we have a stable political system and that is commendable.

PINKY PRADHAN, *Delhi*

Bangladesh needs a strong, young leadership. It's time the *begums* retired and the army stepped down. If the political situation does not stabilise soon, the economic decay will only get worse.

J. KRISHNAN, *Chennai*

Southern Discomfort

Dayanidhi Maran's dismissal from the Cabinet proves only one thing: it is not sufficient to be a good and efficient leader in politics ("Uncivil War", May 28). What matters is your relationship with the party and its leader. It's disheartening to see him go.

MADHUSUDAN VITTAL
on e-mail

With Maran's expulsion, all eyes are now on the DMK supremo. He has been foolish enough to reveal his own insecurity and selfishness which might come in his way while fighting the next election.

S. LAKSHMI, *on e-mail*